1887 Rules of Play

Oct 4, 2026 · @jON

Railways, Banks & Panic in Argentina

1. Introduction

1.1 Overview

1887 is a game for 2, 3 or 4 players. The two player game is a prototype with a few changes, described in 17. Players invest in corporations and run them. There are three kinds of **corporation**. **Finance Houses** fund and control **Construction Companies**. Construction Companies fund and control **Railways**. Only Railways lay track, run trains and earn revenue.

A corporation can own shares in the corporations below it, can start corporations in the tier directly below it, and can be their president. The player who is president of a corporation, or of the corporation that presides over it, makes every decision for it.

Money earned by a Railway is paid to its shareholders. Where a shareholder is a corporation, the money can be passed on to that corporation's shareholders in turn. Share prices rise and fall as shares are bought and sold and as dividends are paid or withheld. When the game ends, the player with the most total wealth wins.

1.2 Contents

- Game board of Argentina
- Stock market board
- 123 track tiles: 72 yellow, 33 green and 18 brown
- 13 corporation charters: 3 Finance Houses, 3 Construction Companies and 7 Railways
- Share certificates: 9 for each Railway, 4 for each Finance House or Construction Company
- 15 private company certificates (16 in a 4 player game)
- Train cards: 2, 3, 4, 5, 6 and Diesel
- Station tokens, as listed on each Railway charter
- 13 price markers, one for each corporation
- Confidence Track and marker
- Priority cards numbered 1 to 4
- Money. The bank never runs out.

1.3 Key Terms

Key terms that have a special meaning in these rules are bold where they are first defined.

- **Share:** the smallest ordinary certificate of a corporation. A share is 10% of a Railway and 20% of a Finance House or Construction Company.
- **President's certificate:** worth two shares. It is 20% of a Railway and 40% of a Finance House or Construction Company.
- **President:** the holder of the largest stake in a corporation. A president can be a player or another corporation (see 5.7).
- **Chain:** a corporation and all the corporations it presides over, directly or through other corporations. The player who is president of the corporation at the top of a chain acts for every corporation in it.
- **Treasury:** a corporation's own cash, together with the shares of that corporation still on its charter.
- **Bank pool:** the shares that have been sold to the bank. Any player or corporation may buy them at the market price.
- **Market price:** the price shown by a corporation's marker on the stock market. A corporation has no market price until its marker is on the market.
- **Par:** the starting price of a corporation. The standard par prices are 156, 130, 108, 92, 76 and 60.
- **Operating Round set:** the Operating Rounds played between two Stock Rounds.
- **Seed certificate:** a certificate dealt during setup.

2. Game Setup

Agree before play which options from section 16 are used. Without options, the game uses friendly mergers (see 9). Then set up as follows.

1. **Starting cash.** Give each player starting cash from the table. The bank has unlimited money.

Players	Starting cash	Certificate limit
3	$700	20
4	$520	16

2. **BAGS and BAWR.** Place the BAGS marker on the stock market at 92 and the BAWR marker at 76. These two Railways do not use the standard par prices. At the end of setup, each receives ten times its price from the bank as a single payment: $920 for BAGS and $760 for BAWR. They float at once and operate in the first Operating Round. All other markers stay beside the board.
3. **Seed certificates.**
    - Deal each player at random one 20% seed certificate in a different Finance House, face up. In a 4 player game there are only three Finance Houses. Three players, chosen at random, receive a Finance House seed certificate and the fourth player instead receives one 10% BAGS certificate.
    - Each Finance House holds a 20% seed certificate in a different Construction Company, dealt at random.
    - Shuffle the four seed Railways: Santa Fe Western (SFW), Bahía Blanca & North Western (BB&NW), Argentine North Western (ANW) and Buenos Aires & Pacific (BA&P). Deal three at random, one to each Construction Company. Each Construction Company holds a 10% seed certificate in its Railway.
    - The fourth seed Railway goes to Lombard Street, along with a 10% BAWR certificate taken from the bank pool (see 11).
    - Seed certificates held by a Finance House or Construction Company belong to that corporation. They do not belong to the player who buys its Charter.
4. **Exchange certificates.** Set aside three 10% BAWR certificates. They are not for sale. They enter play only through the exchange private companies (see 5.9).
5. **Other BAGS and BAWR certificates.** The president's certificate of each Railway comes with its Concession. Every other certificate of BAGS and BAWR starts in the bank pool, apart from the certificates already dealt and the exchange certificates. The three BAGS certificates bundled with private companies are taken from the bank pool when those private companies are bought.
6. **Confidence Track.** Place its marker on space 1.
7. **Priority cards.** Place cards 1 to 4 (cards 1 to 3 with three players) near the board.
8. **Private companies.** Deal the private company certificates face up: 5 to each player in a 3 player game (15 items) and 4 to each player in a 4 player game (16 items). Estancia Land Grant is used only in a 4 player game. Every player can see every item.
9. **Auction.** Run the Initial Auction (see 4). Then begin the first Stock Round.

3. Game Overview

The game is a repeating series of rounds.

- **Initial Auction.** Played once, at the start of the game.
- **Stock Round.** Players buy and sell shares.

- **Operating Round set.** One, two or three Operating Rounds, depending on the game phase (see 12). In each Operating Round the corporations operate.
- **Merger Round.** Played after each Operating Round set, only in games that use a merger variant (see 16).

The game then continues with another Stock Round and another Operating Round set, until one of the end conditions in section 13 is met.

As trains are bought, the game moves through phases. The first purchase of each new type of train starts a new phase, which changes the number of Operating Rounds in a set, the train limit, the tiles that can be used and other rules (see 12).

4. Initial Auction

4.1 Procedure

1. A random player is the first **auctioneer**. Turn order is clockwise.
2. The auctioneer chooses one item from their own hand and offers it for sale.
3. Only the two players seated to the auctioneer's left may bid on that item. The nearer player acts first. A player may pass, or bid at least $5 more than the face value, in multiples of $5. A player may never bid more than the cash they have. If the nearer player passes and the farther player then bids, the nearer player may bid again. Passing once does not remove a player from the auction. The auction ends when both players have had a chance to bid and one of them passes. The other player wins the item and pays their bid.
4. If both players pass, the item is forced onto the next player clockwise, at face value. In a 3 player game this can be the auctioneer.
5. If the forced buyer cannot afford the item, the richest player must buy it instead.
6. If nobody can afford the item, every private company pays its revenue to its owner at once. Repeat this until the richest player can afford the item. That player buys it.
7. All payments go to the bank. The only exception is the payment for a Charter (see 4.2).
8. When the item is sold, the auctioneer role passes to the player on the left. Repeat from step 2.
9. The auction ends when every item has been sold.

A change of presidency takes effect at once, even during the auction. For example, a player who holds more shares of BAGS than the owner of its Concession becomes its president (see 5.7).

4.2 What the Items Give

- **Charters.** A Charter is the 40% president's certificate of a Finance House: the Baring Charter for Baring Brothers, the Hambro Charter for C.J. Hambro & Co. and the Murrieta

Charter for E. Murrieta & Co. The winning bid is paid into that Finance House's Treasury, not to the bank. The buyer receives the president's certificate. The Finance House floats at once. Its par is the highest standard par that does not exceed half the winning bid, and its marker is placed on the market at that price. The Charter then stays on the buyer's card, counting toward no limit and no score, and closes at the start of the first Stock Round.

- **Concessions.** The BAGS Concession and the BAWR Concession each bring the 20% president's certificate of that Railway.
- **Private companies with a BAGS share.** Baring & Robertson Credit, Petro & Ladd Construction Contract and Robert Stephenson & Co. Locomotive Order each bring one free 10% BAGS share from the bank pool.
- **Lombard Street.** The buyer becomes its owner (see 11).
- **Other private companies.** The buyer owns the private company and receives its revenue and ability (see 14).

Example: Ann offers the Hambro Charter and Bob wins it with a bid of $200. Half of $200 is $100, and the highest standard par that does not exceed $100 is 92. Bob pays $200 into the Treasury of C.J. Hambro & Co., takes its 40% president's certificate, and its marker is placed at 92.

4.3 Order of the First Stock Round

When the auction ends, the player with the least cash receives priority card 1, the player with the next least cash receives card 2, and so on. Ties are broken by auction order: the first auctioneer comes first, then clockwise.

5. Stock Round

During a Stock Round players buy and sell shares. Corporations take no actions.

5.1 Stock Market

All thirteen corporations share one market. Any number of markers can be in the same cell. A marker that enters a cell goes on the bottom of the stack there.

A corporation has a market price only when its marker is on the market. Shares of a corporation whose marker is not on the market cannot be sold by anyone. They can be bought only while a player is founding the corporation (see 7.4 and 10.1), at par.

Every share of a corporation is worth the current price, whether it is a 10% share or a 20% share.

Markers move in these ways.

- Paying a dividend moves a marker one space to the right. Withholding earnings, or earning nothing, moves it one space to the left.
- Each share that is sold moves a marker down one row. Each share that is issued moves a marker down one row. A sold out corporation moves up one row at the end of a Stock Round.
- If a marker must move left but is in the leftmost column, it moves down one row instead.
- If a marker must move right but is in the rightmost column, it moves up one row instead.
- If a marker must move up but is in the top row, or must move down but is in the bottom row, it does not move.

If any marker reaches 516, the game ends at once (see 13).

5.2 Priority Cards and Turn Order

Players take turns in the order of their priority cards, starting with card 1. For the first Stock Round, see 4.3.

- A player who passes takes the lowest numbered card that no other player holds.
- A player who holds a card and acts instead of passing gives up the card. The players holding higher numbered cards each move up one number.
- A player who has passed may act when play comes back to them.
- The Stock Round ends when every player holds a card.

The player with card 1 goes first in the next Stock Round.

5.3 A Turn

On a turn a player may do these things in this order: sell any number of shares, buy one certificate, and then sell any number of shares again. Any of these may be skipped. A player may also, on their turn, start a company (see 5.8), exchange a certificate (see 5.9), direct Lombard Street (see 11.2) or use Baring & Robertson Credit (see 11.4). Directing Lombard Street counts as the player's buy for the turn.

A player who sells, buys, exchanges or takes any other action has not passed. A player who does none of these passes.

5.4 Selling Shares

- A player may sell any number of shares they hold, in any corporation. A president may sell the president's certificate only as described below.

- The seller receives the market price for each share. Shares of one corporation that are sold together are all paid at the price before the first of them is sold. The price then drops one row for each share sold.
- No sale may put more than 50% of a corporation's shares into the bank pool.
- A president may sell the president's certificate, or sell shares in a way that takes him below it, only if another holder has at least two shares. The holder who becomes president takes the certificate (see 5.7). If the president sells the whole certificate, it counts as two shares in the sale, and the new president gives two of their own shares to the bank pool in exchange. A president who holds only the certificate may sell one share: the new president gives him two ordinary shares in exchange, and he sells one of them and keeps the other. If no other holder has at least two shares, the president's certificate cannot be sold.
- A player may not buy a certificate of a corporation after selling a share of it earlier in the same Stock Round.

Corporations sell shares by the same rules. The money goes into the corporation's Treasury.

5.5 Buying Shares

A player may buy one certificate on a turn, from a corporation's Treasury or from the bank pool, at the market price. If it comes from a Treasury, the money is paid into that corporation's Treasury. If it comes from the bank pool, the money is paid to the bank.

There is no initial offering. Every certificate is held by a player, by a corporation, in a corporation's Treasury, or in the bank pool. The only payment made at par is the founding payment when a company is started (see 5.8). A player never buys a president's certificate except in the cases in 5.8, 10 and 11.

5.6 Certificate Limit and Control Limit

Certificate limit. A certificate is any share certificate, including a president's certificate, or any private company. A player may never buy a certificate that takes them over the limit in the table in section 2. A player who is over the limit at the start of their turn must sell down to it first, before anything else. The Lombard Street private company counts as one certificate for its owner. The certificates and cash that Lombard Street itself holds do not count (see 11).

Control limit. A player's control of a corporation is the total of the shares the player holds in it plus the shares held in it by every corporation in the chains the player is president of, at any depth. A player may not control more than 60% of a corporation. A purchase or a start that would take a player's control over 60% is not allowed. The shares held by Lombard Street do not count toward its owner's control, but Lombard Street itself may not hold more than 60% of a corporation.

Example: Ann is president of Baring Brothers, which holds 30% of SFW. Ann herself holds 20% of SFW. Ann controls 50% of SFW. She may buy one more 10% share, which takes her to 60%, but not two.

Control can pass 60% without a purchase or a start, for example after an exchange, a merger or a change of president. Nothing is sold, and no player or corporation is ever forced to sell because of the control limit, with one exception: the winner of a purchase of control who ends over 60% must sell down (see 16.6). Until the player's control is back at 60% or below, neither the player nor any corporation in the player's chains may buy or start any more of that corporation.

5.7 Change of President

The president of a corporation is the holder with the largest stake in it. A holder can be a player, a corporation or Lombard Street. The president's certificate is worth two shares, so a holder needs at least two shares to become president.

When another holder has more shares than the president, that holder becomes president at once. The new president takes the president's certificate and gives the old president two ordinary shares in exchange, so each keeps the same total percentage. If the president is among the holders tied for the most shares, the president keeps the presidency. If the president is not among them, which happens when the president sells the president's certificate, the presidency goes to the tied holder who comes first after the old president in the turn order, that is, the order of the player names shown on screen.

When a corporation is president, the player at the top of its chain acts for it. Lombard Street's owner acts for any corporation Lombard Street presides over.

5.8 Starting Companies

A player may not start a Construction Company or a Railway, and may not buy a president's certificate from a Treasury. A Finance House starts a Construction Company, and a Construction Company starts a Railway, during an Operating Round (see 7.4). These are the exceptions.

- Lombard Street may start a Construction Company or a Railway (see 11).
- **Entre Ríos.** From the first 4-train on, a Construction Company may start Entre Ríos, or any player may start it as their buy for the turn. A player who starts it chooses a par from the standard list and pays twice par to the bank for the 20% president's certificate. All its other certificates are in the bank pool and cost par each, paid to the bank. It floats when 60% of its certificates have been sold. The bank then pays ten times par into its Treasury and its home station is placed in the Entre Ríos hex. Its marker is placed on the market at par at the start of the next Operating Round. Until then its unsold certificates stay for sale at par each, paid to the bank, and any player may buy them, even after it has floated. Nobody may sell its shares before its marker is on the market, and the 50% limit

on the bank pool does not apply while it is being founded. It has no trains and no seed shares.

- **Seed Railways started by a player.** From the first 4-train on, any player may start SFW, BB&NW, ANW or BA&P, if it has never been started, as their buy for the turn. It is founded as Entre Ríos is. The player chooses a par from the standard list and pays twice par to the bank for the 20% president's certificate. Its other certificates, except the seed share held by its Construction Company, are in the bank pool and cost par each, paid to the bank. It floats when 60% of its certificates have been sold, and the seed share counts as sold. The bank then pays ten times par into its Treasury, and its home station is placed. Its marker is placed on the market at par at the start of the next Operating Round. Until then its unsold certificates stay for sale at par each, paid to the bank, and any player may buy them, even after it has floated. Nobody may sell its shares before its marker is on the market.
- A retired Railway or Finance House may be started again (see 10).

5.9 Exchange Certificates

A player who owns Henderson Transfer, La Porteña Works or Anderson Paz Purchase Agreement may exchange each of them during a Stock Round for one of the three held back 10% BAWR shares. A player may exchange any number of them in one turn. An exchange costs nothing and the private company closes. An exchange is not a buy. A player may exchange and still sell and buy on the same turn. A player who exchanges has acted and has not passed. An exchange may take a player over the certificate limit, and the player must then sell down (see 5.3). It may also take a player over 60% of BAWR, and the player keeps the shares (see 5.6).

When the first 5-train is bought, each unused exchange private company closes and its owner receives the BAWR certificate (see 14).

5.10 End of the Stock Round

The Stock Round ends when every player holds a priority card. Every corporation with a market price whose shares are all held by players, corporations or Lombard Street, with none in the bank pool and none in any Treasury, is sold out. The BAWR shares held back for the exchange certificates count as held by players for this test. Sold out corporations move up one row, in descending order of price.

6. Operating Round

6.1 Order of Play

At the start of each Operating Round the private companies pay their owners (see 6.2). Then each floated corporation operates once, in descending order of share price. If two corporations

have the same price, the one whose marker is further to the right operates first. If their markers are in the same cell, the one higher in the stack operates first.

The order is not fixed at the start of the round. Whenever a price changes, for any reason, recheck the order of the corporations that have not yet operated. A corporation that has already operated does not operate again that round, even if its price changes later.

A corporation that is started or floated during an Operating Round does not operate in that round. Its marker waits beside the market and is placed on the market at its par, on the bottom of the stack, at the start of the next Operating Round. Until then the corporation has no market price.

6.2 Private Companies

At the start of each Operating Round, before any corporation operates, each private company pays its revenue to its owner. If a Railway owns the private company, the revenue is paid into the Railway's Treasury. Private companies are never traded between players. The roster in section 14 gives the revenue and ability of each one and says when it closes.

6.3 Railways Buying Private Companies

From the green phase on (see 12), during its turn a Railway may buy any of these private companies, one after another: Kilometric Guarantee, La Boca Docks Lease, Paraná Ferry Company and Estancia Land Grant. The player who acts for the Railway, which is the player at the top of its chain, must own the private company. In this section, the Railway's president means that player.

- The president and the Railway agree a price from half to double the face value, inclusive. Half of an odd face value is rounded up.
- The Railway pays the price from its Treasury to the owner. If its Treasury cannot pay it, the purchase cannot be made.
- The private company's ability then applies to the Railway. Its revenue is paid into the Railway's Treasury. It cannot be sold again, and it closes when section 14 says.

6.4 Number of Operating Rounds

An Operating Round set has one Operating Round until the first 3-train is bought, two Operating Rounds after that, and three Operating Rounds after the first 5-train is bought. A change takes effect for sets that begin after the purchase. The set in progress keeps its number of Operating Rounds.

7. Finance Houses and Construction Companies

7.1 The Financial Turn

A Finance House or Construction Company never lays track, places station tokens, runs trains or buys trains. On its turn it may first sell shares it holds in other companies (see 7.2). It then takes one action: Buy, Start, Redeem or Issue, described below. In a game that uses no merger variant, it may instead propose a Merger (see 9).

If a corporation neither sells nor takes an action, its price moves one space to the left.

7.2 Selling Shares

Before its action, a corporation may sell shares it holds in other companies. The rules in 5.4 apply. The shares are paid at the market price, which is paid into its Treasury. The price of the company whose shares are sold drops one row for each share sold, and a sale may change that company's president. A corporation may not buy a share of a company in the same turn in which it sold a share of that company. A corporation that sells has acted and does not take the penalty in 7.1.

7.3 Buy

The corporation buys one share from the Treasury or the bank pool of a company in a tier below it, at the market price, and pays from its own Treasury.

- A Finance House may buy shares in Construction Companies and in Railways.
- A Construction Company may buy shares in Railways.
- A corporation never buys upward or sideways. A Construction Company may not buy a Finance House share, and no corporation may buy a share in another corporation of its own tier.
- A corporation never buys a president's certificate this way.
- The company must have a market price, and the control limit in 5.6 applies to the player at the top of the buying corporation's chain.

A purchase that makes the buyer the largest holder gives it the presidency at once (see 5.7). A Finance House that becomes president of a Railway this way makes all its decisions through its chain, but a Finance House can never start a Railway.

7.4 Start

A Finance House starts a Construction Company that has never been started. A Construction Company starts a Railway that has never been started, which is one of the four seed Railways (SFW, BB&NW, ANW and BA&P) or, from the first 4-train on, Entre Ríos. From the first 4-train on, any player may also start any Railway that has never been started, as their buy for the turn. A

Railway that a merger has retired is not a Railway that has never been started. It is restarted as described in 10, and the first 4-train condition does not apply to it.

- The starter pays at least $120, in multiples of $5, from its Treasury.
- The par of the new company is the highest standard par that does not exceed half the amount paid.
- The whole amount is paid into the new company's Treasury, and the starter takes its president's certificate.
- Each Construction Company and each of the four seed Railways receives a one time subsidy from the bank equal to its par, paid into its Treasury. Entre Ríos and restarted companies receive no subsidy.
- The company floats at once. Its marker waits beside the market until the start of the next Operating Round (see 6.1).

Example: a Finance House pays $310 to start BWW. Half of $310 is $155, and the highest standard par that does not exceed $155 is 130. BWW's Treasury receives $310 plus a $130 subsidy, and the Finance House takes the 40% president's certificate.

7.5 Redeem

The corporation buys back one of its own shares from the bank pool at the market price, paying from its Treasury. The price does not move.

7.6 Issue

The corporation moves any number of shares from its own Treasury to the bank pool. They are all sold together at the market price per share, and the money is paid into its Treasury. The price then drops one row for each share issued. The 50% limit on the bank pool applies. A corporation cannot Issue if that would change its president.

7.7 Merge

A Merge is described in section 9.

8. Railways

8.1 A Railway's Turn

The Railway's president acts for it. A turn has these steps, in this order.

1. Issue or Redeem one share (optional, see 8.2).
2. Lay or upgrade track (see 8.3).

3. Place a station token (see 8.4).
4. Run trains (see 8.5).
5. Pay or withhold dividends (see 8.6 and 8.7).
6. Buy trains (see 8.8). This is required if the Railway has a valid route and no train.

A Railway may buy a private company at any point in its turn (see 6.3).

8.2 Issue or Redeem

Before it lays track, a Railway may Issue one share or Redeem one share, but not both.

- **Issue.** Move one share from the Railway's Treasury to the bank pool. The Railway receives the market price into its Treasury, and its price drops one row. The 50% limit on the bank pool applies. The president's certificate and the held back exchange certificates are never issued.
- **Redeem.** The Railway spends Treasury cash to buy back one of its own shares from the bank pool at the market price. The price does not move. BAGS and BAWR may not Redeem.

8.3 Track

A Railway takes two track actions per turn, on two different hexes. It may place two tiles, or place one tile and upgrade one tile, in either order. It may not upgrade a tile it has placed in the same turn.

An upgrade must keep all existing track. The upgrade order is yellow, green and brown. The colors that may be used depend on the phase (see 12). Towns cannot be upgraded. New track must connect to track that the Railway can reach from one of its station tokens.

The terrain cost printed on the map is paid from the Railway's Treasury when a tile is laid and again when a tile is upgraded. No tile is laid in hexes F24 and G21, which have printed ferry track (see 15). Hex J10 is blocked while a player owns Estancia Land Grant (see 14).

8.4 Station Tokens

Each Railway places its first station token, its home station, free on its home hex. A Railway may place one more token on its turn in a city with an open space, paying from its Treasury: $40 for the second token, and $80 for the third and fourth tokens. A Railway may not have two tokens in one city.

Railway	Home	Tokens

BAGS	Buenos Aires	3
BAWR	Buenos Aires (Oeste)	3
SFW	Rosario	4
BB&NW	Bahía Blanca	3
ANW	Tucumán	4
BA&P	San Luis	3
ER	Entre Ríos hex	3

8.5 Routes and Revenue

A route is a continuous path of track that connects at least two revenue centers and includes a station token of the Railway. Revenue centers are towns, cities and off board locations. A Railway has a valid route if one of its station tokens connects by track to another revenue center.

A train runs to as many revenue centers as its number. A Diesel runs to any number. Off board locations end a route and cannot be passed through. A city whose spaces are all filled by the tokens of other Railways can be entered but not passed through. Only a Railway that owns the Paraná Ferry Company may run a route over hexes F24 and G21.

The revenue of a Railway is the total value of the revenue centers on the routes its president chooses. The president is expected to choose the best routes, and any other player may point out a better one.

8.6 Dividends

The president chooses to pay or withhold the earnings.

Pay. Divide the earnings by the Railway's 10 shares. The president's certificate counts as two shares. Round down to whole dollars per share. Each holder receives that amount for each share it holds: cash for a player, a payment into the Treasury for a corporation, and a payment into the Treasury of Lombard Street. Shares in the bank pool pay their part to the bank. Shares in the Railway's own Treasury pay their part to the Railway. Any remainder stays with the Railway. The Railway's price moves one space to the right.

Withhold. The earnings go into the Railway's Treasury. The price moves one space to the left.

8.7 Dividends Up the Chain

When a payment reaches a corporation that is president of the Railway paying it, that corporation moves one space to the right at once. Its own president then chooses at once, before play continues, to pay the money on or to withhold it.

- **Pay on.** Divide the money by that corporation's 5 shares, round down, and pay its holders in the same way. The corporation then moves one more space to the right. If any of the money reaches another corporation that is its president, the same steps are repeated there.
- **Withhold.** The money stays in the corporation's Treasury. Its price stays where the first move put it, and nothing passes further up.
- **Less than $1 per share.** A corporation may pay on only if each share receives at least $1. If not, it must withhold, and it moves one space to the left. It then ends where it started.

A corporation moves at most two spaces for each payment it receives. This applies whether the paying company is one tier below the corporation or two. A corporation that holds shares in the paying company but is not its president keeps the payment in its Treasury. It makes no choice and does not move. Any remainder stays with the corporation that pays.

Example: BBNW earns $60 and pays $6 per share. J&MC is its president and holds three shares, so it receives $18 and moves one space right. J&MC's president chooses to pay on. J&MC has 5 shares, so each share receives $3. J&MC moves one more space right. BB, which holds three shares of J&MC and is its president, receives $9 and repeats the same steps.

8.8 Trains

A Railway that has a valid route must own a train, and must buy one before its turn ends if it has none.

- A Railway buys the next train in the depot at face value, one train at a time.
- A Railway may instead buy a train from another Railway if the presidents of both agree. The price is any amount of at least $1, with no upper limit other than the cash available

to the buyer. If the two presidents are different players, the buying player confirms that the other has agreed.

- A Railway never sells or offers a train. A train moves to another Railway only when that Railway buys it.
- A Railway may not buy a train that would take it over the train limit (see 12). When the limit drops, a Railway with too many trains discards the extra ones, and its president chooses which. Discarded trains are removed from the game.
- When the first train of a new type is bought, older trains rust and are removed from all Railways (see 12).

8.9 Emergency Money

A Railway with a valid route and no train that cannot afford a train raises the money in this order. It may instead use these steps to buy a train from another Railway at an agreed price (see 8.8).

1. The Railway pays all the cash in its Treasury. It never issues shares in an emergency.
2. If the Railway's president is a corporation, the call goes to that corporation. It gives cash from its Treasury to the Railway, as a gift that is never repaid. If that is not enough, it raises more by selling shares it holds in companies outside its own chain, and gives that too. It never sells shares of a company it presides over, directly or through other corporations, and it never issues shares in an emergency. If it still cannot cover the whole amount, its price moves one space to the left and the call goes to its president.
3. The call climbs one tier at a time. Each corporation it passes takes the same one space penalty.
4. When the call reaches a player, the player pays cash first, then sells shares. Nobody sells more than the shortfall needs. A player who is still short after selling everything they legally can must declare bankruptcy (see 8.10).

No sale during an emergency may change the president of the Railway that needs the train. If a sale would do so, that share cannot be sold. Another share is chosen instead, or the corporation counts as unable to raise that cash. A sale may change the president of any other company. The 50% limit on the bank pool applies to every emergency sale, so at most 40% of a Finance House or Construction Company can be in the pool. The player at the top of the chain chooses which shares a Finance House or Construction Company sells. Only a player can declare bankruptcy. A Finance House or Construction Company never does. If Lombard Street is president, its Treasury pays first and its owner pays after it. Lombard Street never sells. A Railway's first Operating Round is not exempt.

Example: ANW has $193 and must buy a 5-train for $400. Its president is Cat, a player. ANW pays its $193, and Cat pays the other $207 from her own cash. If she did not have it, she would sell shares she holds, but never so many that she loses the presidency of ANW.

8.10 Bankruptcy

A player may declare bankruptcy only when a Railway they act for needs a train and all of these are true: the Railway cannot afford a train from the depot or the bank pool, the player cannot raise the money (see 8.9), and no Railway that the player controls holds a train that could be bought. A train held by a Railway that another player controls does not prevent bankruptcy, because that player may refuse to sell it. A player is also bankrupt, without declaring it, if they cannot pay an amount that the rules make them pay personally (see 14.4), even after selling every share they may sell.

When a player declares bankruptcy, the game ends at once. The player keeps their cash and shares, is scored like every other player, and may win (see 13).

9. Mergers

In a **merger**, two companies of the same tier combine into one. This section gives the base rules, called the friendly merger, where a corporation proposes a merger on its own turn. In a game that uses a merger variant, mergers are made in a Merger Round instead (see 16).

9.1 When a Merger Is Allowed

- No merger may be made until the first 3-train has been bought.
- A Construction Company proposes a merger of two Railways if it is president of at least one of them. A Finance House proposes a merger of two Construction Companies if it is president of at least one of them. A Finance House may propose a merger of itself with another Finance House on its own turn.
- Both companies must have taken at least one turn in an Operating Round.
- Both companies must have a market price. A retired company cannot merge.
- BAWR cannot merge while its held back exchange certificates are unused (see 5.9).
- At least one holder must be able to become president of the new company (see 9.6).

9.2 Agreement

If one player is the top of the chain for both companies, no agreement is needed. If different players are the top of the chains, the other player must agree. The proposing player confirms that the other has agreed.

9.3 The Surviving Charter

For two Railways, the one with the higher station limit keeps its charter (see 8.4). For two Construction Companies or two Finance Houses, the one with the higher price keeps its charter. If they tie, the proposing player chooses. The other charter is retired (see 10).

The survivor receives all the cash, trains, private companies and station tokens of the retired company, and all the shares the retired company held in other companies. Where the retired company was president of another company, the survivor becomes its president.

9.4 Exchange of Shares

Add up the shares each holder has in the two companies, counting a president's certificate as two shares. Every two shares become one share of the survivor. A single leftover share is an **unpaired share**.

The survivor has the normal certificates of its tier: a 20% president's certificate and eight 10% shares for a Railway, and a 40% president's certificate and three 20% shares for a Finance House or Construction Company. The new shares are given out to holders in this order.

1. The player at the top of the proposing company's chain.
2. The other players, clockwise from that player.
3. Corporations, in descending order of price.
4. Lombard Street.
5. The bank pool.

Shares in a Treasury are paired in the same way and stay in the survivor's Treasury. Shares in the bank pool are paired and stay in the bank pool. An unpaired share in the bank pool is discarded. A share that nobody receives is placed in the bank pool. After a merger the bank pool may hold more than 50% of the survivor. This is allowed, and the 50% limit then only blocks selling and issuing.

Example: Cat holds four shares of one Railway and three of the other. She has seven shares, so she receives three new shares and has one unpaired share.

9.5 Unpaired Shares

Each holder with an unpaired share chooses, one at a time, in this order: corporations in descending order of price (ties are decided as in 6.1), then players in priority card order, and Lombard Street last.

- **Take cash.** The holder gives up the share and receives half the new price from the bank, rounded down.
- **Buy.** The holder pays half the new price, rounded down, to the bank and takes one whole share. This is possible only while a share that nobody received is still in the bank pool.

Lombard Street pays from its Treasury first, and then its owner pays the rest. A Treasury with an unpaired share receives half the new price from the bank and keeps one whole share. Buy is not

limited by the certificate limit or the control limit. A holder who ends over the certificate limit must sell down (see 5.3). A holder who ends over 60% keeps the shares (see 5.6).

9.6 President

The first holder in the order in 9.4 who has at least two new shares becomes president of the survivor. That holder takes the president's certificate in exchange for two of its new ordinary shares. If no holder has two shares, the merger cannot be made.

A change of president in any other company that results from the merger is made at once (see 5.7).

9.7 Price

The new price is the average of the two prices, rounded to the nearest price on the market. If it falls exactly between two prices, the lower one is used. The survivor's marker moves to that space and goes on the bottom of the stack. The marker of the retired company is removed.

9.8 Stations and Trains

The survivor keeps its station tokens up to its limit, with no more than one token in a city, and at least one. If it has too many, its president removes the extra tokens. Where both companies have a token in the same city, the survivor's token replaces the other at no cost. Trains above the limit are discarded and removed from the game, and the president chooses which.

9.9 After the Merger

The survivor operates in the current round only if neither of the merged companies has already operated in it. The retired charter is reset as an unstarted company (see 10). The survivor may merge again once it has taken a turn in an Operating Round.

10. Restarting Charters

A retired charter has no owner, shares, cash, trains, tokens, private companies or price. It may be started again by the rules below. A charter that has never been started follows 5.8 and 7.4, and cannot be started by these rules.

10.1 Retired Railway

A retired Railway is started again in one of two ways.

- **By a Construction Company.** The Construction Company starts it as in 7.4, with no subsidy.
- **By a player.** The player does this as their buy for the turn in a Stock Round. The player chooses a par from the standard list and pays twice par to the bank for the 20% president's certificate. All its other shares are in the bank pool and cost par each, paid to the bank. The Railway floats when 60% of its shares have been sold, and the bank then pays ten times par into its Treasury. Its marker goes on the market at par at the start of the next Operating Round. Until then its unsold shares stay for sale at par each, paid to the bank, and any player may buy them, even after it has floated. Nobody may sell its shares before its marker is on the market, and the 50% limit does not apply while it is being founded.

Lombard Street may start a retired Railway by buying its president's certificate (see 11).

A restarted Railway has no fixed home. When its president's certificate is bought, the buyer also chooses its home city, which is any city with an open station space that is connected by track to Buenos Aires. Its first station token is placed there at once. If there is no such city, the president's certificate cannot be bought and the Railway cannot be started. The Railway has no trains.

10.2 Retired Construction Company

A Finance House or Lombard Street starts it as in 7.4, with no subsidy.

10.3 Retired Finance House

Any player may start it as their buy for the turn in a Stock Round. The player pays any amount of at least $120, in multiples of $5, into its Treasury. Its par is the highest standard par that does not exceed half the amount, and the player takes the 40% president's certificate. The Finance House floats at once, with no subsidy. Its marker goes on the market at par at the start of the next Operating Round.

10.4 A New Company

A restarted company is a new company. It has its full set of certificates, with all the shares not taken by its starter in its Treasury, fresh station tokens and no seed shares. A retired charter cannot be bought, merged or operated until it has been started again.

11. Lombard Street and the Confidence Track

11.1 Lombard Street

Lombard Street is bought in the Initial Auction as a private company for $135. Its buyer becomes its owner and acts for it. It then has a Treasury of its own, which starts at $0 and is separate from the owner's cash. The Lombard Street private company never closes. It stays on its owner's card for the whole game.

- At setup it holds a 10% BAWR share and a 10% share of the fourth seed Railway (see 2).
- It collects dividends on every share it holds, and the money goes into its Treasury.
- Its shares and cash do not count against its owner's certificate limit (see 5.6). Its shares do not count toward its owner's control. It may not hold more than 60% of a corporation.
- It counts as a holder when the president of a corporation is decided (see 5.7). It is part of a chain only while it holds a president's certificate.
- It never sells shares by choice. In an emergency, its Treasury pays first and its owner pays the rest (see 8.9).

11.2 Lombard Street's Action

Once per Stock Round, on the owner's turn, the owner may direct Lombard Street to do one of the following. This counts as the owner's buy for that turn, and the owner may not also buy a certificate of their own on that turn.

- **Buy a share.** Lombard Street buys one share from a Treasury or from the bank pool at the market price. It never buys a president's certificate this way.
- **Start a company.** Lombard Street starts a Construction Company or a Railway by buying its president's certificate. The owner chooses the par from the standard list. The price is twice par, paid into the new company's Treasury, and the one time subsidy in 7.4 applies. Lombard Street may start a Railway that has never been started only from the first 4-train on, as a player may. BAGS and BAWR float at setup, so Lombard Street can start them only after a merger has retired them. Lombard Street may also start a retired Construction Company or Railway (see 10).

Lombard Street pays as much of the price as its Treasury allows. The owner pays the rest from personal cash.

In the final Stock Round only (see 13), the price Lombard Street pays is the market price one space to the left (or one row down at the edge). The price of the company itself does not move.

11.3 The Confidence Track

The Confidence Track has 7 spaces. Its marker starts on space 1. Each time Lombard Street buys a share, including a president's certificate when it starts a company, the marker moves one space forward. When the marker reaches space 7, the end of the game begins (see 13).

11.4 Baring & Robertson Credit

Once per game, the owner of Baring & Robertson Credit may move the marker on the Confidence Track back one space. This is done during the owner's own Stock Round turn. It does not use the owner's buy, but it counts as an action, so the player has not passed. The marker cannot be moved back from space 7.

12. Game Phases

12.1 Trains

There are six types of train. A Railway can own no more trains than the train limit of the current phase.

Train	Cost	Number	Rusts
2	$80	7	no train
3	$150	5	no train
4	$250	3	all 2-trains
5	$400	3	all 3-trains
6	$500	3 (2 with the Two 6-trains option)	all 4-trains
Diesel	$700	unlimited	all 5-trains

Trains are bought in order. All trains of one type must be bought before the next type is available. When the first train of a type is bought, the trains it rusts are removed from all Railways at once. The table shows the standard game. The options Two 6-trains, Permanent 5-trains and Four 4-trains change it (see 16).

12.2 Phases

The game moves through phases, named after the train type whose first purchase starts them. The number of Operating Rounds in a set changes only for sets that begin after the purchase. The set in progress keeps its number. Every other effect of a phase begins the moment the train is bought.

Phase	Starts when	Operating Rounds per set	Train limit	Other effects
2	The game begins	1	4	Yellow tiles only
3	First 3-train is bought	2	4	Green tiles. Railways may buy private companies. Mergers are allowed
4	First 4-train is bought	2	3	Entre Ríos may be started
5	First 5-train is bought	3	3	Brown tiles. Kilometric Guarantee pays $7 per token. Private companies close (see 14). The last BAWR exchange certificate is forced
6	First 6-train is bought	3	2	Kilometric Guarantee clawback (see 14)

D	First Diesel is bought	3	2	The end of the game begins (see 13)

13. End of the Game

13.1 End Conditions

The game ends when any of these happens.

1. The marker on the Confidence Track reaches space 7.
2. The first Diesel is bought.
3. A player declares bankruptcy (see 8.10).
4. All players agree that one of them has already won. Any player then ends the game with the End Game command in the Tools menu.
5. The price of any corporation reaches 516.

Bankruptcy, the agreement of all players and a price of 516 end the game at once, with no further play, and can happen at any time. For condition 2, finish the current Operating Round set, then play one final Stock Round and one final Operating Round set. For condition 1, finish the Stock Round in progress, then play one full Operating Round set with no further Stock Round. If both condition 1 and condition 2 happen, only the first counts.

13.2 Scoring

Each player's final score is the total of these.

- Their cash.
- Every certificate they hold, at the price it ended on.
- The face value of every private company they own.

In addition:

- A certificate held by a Finance House or Construction Company in a company outside its own chain counts for the player at the top of that holder's chain, at its market price.
- A certificate in a company that never reached the market counts as $60.
- A certificate in a corporation's own Treasury counts for nobody.
- Lombard Street's whole value, which is all its cash and every certificate it holds at the final price, is added to the score of its owner. The $135 face value of the Lombard Street private company is not scored.

- A player who has declared bankruptcy keeps their cash and certificates and is scored like every other player.

The player with the highest total wins. If players tie for the highest total, they share the win.

14. Private Company Roster

Private companies are bought in the Initial Auction. A player who owns one receives its revenue at the start of each Operating Round (see 6.2). A private company marked **Railway may buy** can be bought by a Railway from its own president from phase 3 on (see 6.3). When a private company closes, its certificate is removed from the game. The start of phase 5 means the moment the first 5-train is bought.

14.1 Presidencies

BAGS Concession. Cost $200. Revenue $60. It carries the 20% president's certificate of BAGS. It closes when BAGS first operates.

BAWR Concession. Cost $200. Revenue $40. It carries the 20% president's certificate of BAWR. It closes when BAWR first operates.

The president's certificate of a Concession can change hands after the purchase like any other certificate (see 5.7). If the presidency moves away from the owner of a Concession, the Concession still pays its revenue until it closes.

Baring Charter, Hambro Charter and Murrieta Charter. Cost $160 each. Each carries the 40% president's certificate of its Finance House. The winning bid is paid into that Finance House's Treasury, and its par follows from the bid (see 4.2). The Finance House holds one 20% seed certificate in a Construction Company, which belongs to the Finance House and not to the buyer. A Charter stays on its owner's card, counting toward no limit and no score, and closes at the start of the first Stock Round.

14.2 Private Companies with a BAGS Share

Each of these three brings one free 10% BAGS share from the bank pool when it is bought. Each closes at the start of phase 5.

Baring & Robertson Credit. Cost $60. Revenue $15. Its ability is described in 11.4. A Railway cannot buy it.

Petro & Ladd Construction Contract. Cost $75. Revenue $15. Railway may not buy.

Robert Stephenson & Co. Locomotive Order. Cost $90. Revenue $15. Railway may not buy. It pays its owner 10% of the price of the first train bought from the depot in each Operating Round set. It closes when the first 5-train is bought, before it pays.

14.3 BAWR Exchange Certificates

Each of these can be exchanged for one of the three held back 10% BAWR shares during a Stock Round (see 5.9). A Railway cannot buy them. When the first 5-train is bought, each one that is still unused closes and its owner receives the BAWR share.

Henderson Transfer. Cost $70. Revenue $15.

La Porteña Works. Cost $85. Revenue $15.

Anderson Paz Purchase Agreement. Cost $55. Revenue $10.

14.4 Other Private Companies

Kilometric Guarantee. Cost $35. Railway may buy. It pays nothing while a player owns it. While a Railway owns it, it pays that Railway $15 for each station token the Railway has placed, including its home station, at the start of each Operating Round, before any corporation acts. From phase 5 it pays $7 per token. At the start of phase 6, the owning Railway pays the bank $15 for each station token it has placed, and the private company closes. If the Railway cannot pay all of it, its president pays the rest from personal cash, selling shares if needed as for a train (see 8.9). A president who still cannot pay is bankrupt (see 8.10).

La Boca Docks Lease. Cost $70. Revenue $15. Railway may buy. The owning Railway pays no terrain cost the first time it lays or upgrades a tile in hex F16 or E17, the approach to Buenos Aires. It closes at the start of phase 5. If a Railway owns it, the revenue goes into the Railway's Treasury.

Paraná Ferry Company. Cost $60. Revenue $15. Railway may buy. Only a Railway that owns it may run a route over hexes F24 and G21 (see 15). It stays open when phase 5 begins and pays no revenue from then on.

Lombard Street. Cost $135. It does not close. It counts as one certificate for its owner, and its face value is not scored (see 11).

Estancia Land Grant (4 player game only). Cost $45. Revenue $5. Railway may buy. No Railway may build track in hex J10 until a Railway has bought this private company or it has closed. It closes at the start of phase 5. When it closes, it pays its owner a flat $50. If a Railway owns it, the $50 goes into the Railway's Treasury.

15. The Map

The board shows the Pampas region of Argentina and the provinces around it. It has 17 cities, 17 town hexes and 56 countryside hexes, which include the hexes with terrain costs. Three of the town hexes (F8, H16 and J12) hold two towns each, so there are 20 towns.

- **Off board locations.** Bolivia/Paraguay is to the north, Andes/Chile to the west, Atlantic Export to the east and Patagonia to the south. Montevideo is east of Buenos Aires and can be reached by a single coastal land connection. A route ends at an off board location.
- **Water.** Nothing can be built on water hexes unless a rule says so.
- **Terrain costs.** Terrain costs are printed on the map. They apply at the Mendoza mountain crossing and around the Buenos Aires approach.
- **Hexes F24 and G21.** These hexes have printed ferry track, and no tile is laid there. Only a Railway that owns the Paraná Ferry Company may run a route over them. They are the only route to Atlantic Export.
- **Hex J10.** Track cannot be built here while Estancia Land Grant is in play (see 14.4).
- **Entre Ríos.** The Entre Ríos hex is reached by ordinary track, with no ferry requirement.

16. Optional Rules and Variants

Options are chosen when the game is created, and every player must agree to them before play begins. There are fourteen options. Twelve change the rules of play, and two change how mergers are made. The option for two player games is described in 17.4.

16.1 Two 6-trains

There are two 6-trains in the depot instead of three.

16.2 No Bank Pool Limit

The 50% limit on the shares in the bank pool does not apply anywhere in the game. It does not limit sales by players, sales and Issues by corporations, or emergency sales.

16.3 Merger Styles

The standard game uses the friendly merger described in section 9. Two variants replace it: the **contested merger** (16.5) and the **purchase of control** (16.6). At most one merger style can be used in a game. The form for creating a game does not allow both to be chosen.

In a game with a merger variant, a corporation cannot propose a merger on its own turn. Mergers are made only in the Merger Round. Once a merger is made, sections 9.3 to 9.9 apply, with the changes given in each variant.

16.4 The Merger Round

In a game with a merger variant, a Merger Round is played after each Operating Round set, before the next Stock Round. No merger may be made until the first 3-train has been bought, so before that the Merger Round is skipped.

In priority order, each player in turn either proposes one merger or passes. Play goes around the table until every player has passed in turn. A player who has passed may propose a merger later in the same Merger Round. Priority cards do not move.

A merger joins two companies of the same tier. Both must have taken at least one turn in an Operating Round and both must have a market price. A retired company cannot be merged. BAWR cannot be merged while its held back exchange certificates are unused. A company that has been merged in this Merger Round cannot be merged again in it.

16.5 Contested Merger

In the contested merger, the shareholders vote and a majority decides. The president of a company cannot stop a merger that the shareholders approve.

Who may propose. Any player who holds at least one share in either company may propose a merger. Shares held through a corporation that the player is president of count, and so do the shares of Lombard Street if the player owns it. A merger cannot be proposed if no holder could become president of the new company (see 9.6). A proposal that has been rejected in this Merger Round cannot be proposed again.

The vote. The proposer votes first, and the other players vote clockwise from the proposer.

- Each holder casts all its votes as one block, yes or no. A holder cannot split its votes or abstain.
- There is one vote for each share. A president's certificate counts as two.
- A player votes their own shares as one block, and the shares of each corporation the player is president of as a separate block. The shares of Lombard Street are voted by its owner as a separate block.
- Shares in a company's own Treasury do not vote.
- The shares in the bank pool vote last. They vote yes if they would be exchanged for shares of higher total value, no if of lower value, and they abstain if the value is the same.
- The merger passes if there are more yes votes than no votes. A tie fails.

If it passes. The merger is made at once. No agreement is needed (see 9.2). In the order of 9.4, the proposing player comes first.

Example: Ann proposes to merge HAM and MUR. Ann holds one share, Bob four and Cat four. Ann and Bob vote yes and Cat, the president of HAM, votes no. The vote is 5 yes and 4 no, so the merger passes.

16.6 Purchase of Control

In the purchase of control, a merger is an auction. The merger always happens once it is announced. The owners of the two companies can defend them only by outbidding.

Who may announce and bid. Any player may announce a merger and bid, with no share in either company needed, if all of these are true.

- The player's personal cash is at least $5 more than the minimum bid.
- The certificates that the player would receive, which are all the new shares that the bought shares become, stay within the player's certificate limit (see 5.3).
- The bought shares make at least two new shares, so that the player can become president, as described below.

Lombard Street does not bid. Its owner bids with their own cash.

Minimum bid. The minimum bid is half the market value of all the shares that players, corporations and Lombard Street hold in the two companies, each share at the price of its own company. Shares in a company's own Treasury and in the bank pool are not counted. The result is rounded up to a multiple of $5.

The auction.

1. The announcer must open the bidding at the minimum bid or higher.
2. Clockwise from the announcer, each eligible player in turn either raises the bid by at least $5 or passes. A pass is final for this merger. A player who has less personal cash than the lowest bid he could make passes automatically, and the game does not ask him.
3. All bids are in multiples of $5, and no player may bid more than their personal cash.
4. The auction ends when all the players but one have passed. That player wins.

Payment. The winner pays the winning bid from personal cash. In return he buys every share that players, corporations and Lombard Street hold in the two companies, and their holders lose those shares. The bid is divided among the holders of shares in the two companies in proportion to the market value of their shares, each share at the price of its own company, as in the minimum bid. A president's certificate counts as two shares. Players receive cash, and a corporation or Lombard Street receives its part in its Treasury. Shares in the bank pool and in a

company's own Treasury receive nothing and are not counted. Amounts are rounded down, and the remainder goes into the Treasury of the new company.

The new company. The merger is made as in 9.3 to 9.9, with this change. The bought shares are paired as in 9.4, counting a president's certificate as two shares, and every two shares become one new share. If the number is odd, one share is left over and is discarded, and its holder has been paid for it like the others. The winner receives all the new shares. He exchanges two of them for the president's certificate and becomes president. Nobody else receives new shares. The shares in the bank pool and in the Treasuries are paired and stay where they are, as in 9.4. If the winner's control of the new company is over 60%, he keeps it until his next turn in a Stock Round. At the start of that turn he must sell shares of it down to 60% before doing anything else. He may sell only certificates he holds himself, and the 50% limit on the bank pool applies. If it blocks part of the sale, he sells what he can and owes the rest at his next turn. While he owes a sale he may not buy or start anything.

Example: Cat announces a merger of J&MC and MEIG. The minimum bid is $360, and Cat opens at $360. Ann holds no shares in either company, and she bids $400. Cat passes, so Ann wins. She pays $400 from her own cash. BB and MUR hold shares of the same value in the two companies, so each receives $200 into its Treasury and loses its shares. The six bought shares become three new shares, and Ann receives all of them. She exchanges two for the president's certificate and becomes president of J&MC, holding the 40% president's certificate and one 20% share, which is 60% of the company.

16.7 Combining Options

The friendly merger is used when neither merger variant is chosen. At most one of the contested merger and the purchase of control can be chosen. Every other option can be used on its own or together with any other option, and with one merger style or none.

16.8 Permanent 5-trains

The 5-train does not rust the 3-trains, and nothing rusts the 5-train. The 6-train rusts the 3-trains, and the Diesel rusts the 4-trains. The 4-train still rusts the 2-trains. In the table in 12.1, the 5-train rusts no train, the 6-train rusts all 3-trains, and the Diesel rusts all 4-trains. A Railway that has more trains than the train limit allows when a train is bought discards the extra trains as usual. All other rules about trains are unchanged.

16.9 Four 4-trains

There are four 4-trains in the depot instead of three.

16.10 Higher Revenues

Every revenue center that a train counts on a route is worth $10 more than its value on the map. This applies to cities, towns and off board locations, and to each town on a tile that has more than one. The number of revenue centers a train may visit does not change. The numbers drawn on the map show the value with the extra $10. The Tiles tab shows the printed values.

16.11 Legacy Emergency Issue

In an emergency train purchase, a Railway and the corporations above it may issue shares from their Treasuries to raise the money, as 8.9 allowed in earlier versions of the game, and the corporations above it may sell shares of companies in their own chain. Without this option, nobody issues shares in an emergency, and a corporation sells only shares of companies outside its own chain. This option is used for games that were started under the earlier rule.

16.12 Legacy Purchase of Control

The purchase of control works as it did before the buyout rule: the holders are paid and keep half their shares, and the winner receives the missing president's certificate from the unissued shares. This option is used for games that were started under the earlier rule. It does nothing without the purchase of control.

16.13 Legacy Merger Split

In the purchase of control, the bid is split in proportion to the number of shares, whatever their company, and the winner may not go over 60% control and is never forced to sell down. This option is used for games that were started under the earlier rule. It does nothing without the purchase of control.

16.14 Strict Home City

A restarted Railway's home city must have a continuous path of track to Buenos Aires. The path may not pass through a city whose spaces are all filled by the tokens of other Railways (see 8.5), through an off board location, or over hexes F24 and G21 (see 15). It may end in Buenos Aires even if its spaces are all filled. Without this option, a home city only has to be connected to Buenos Aires by track, whatever tokens stand in the cities on the way (see 10.1).

16.15 Open Ferry

The Paraná Ferry Company closes at the start of phase 6, as Kilometric Guarantee does. From then on, any Railway may run a route over hexes F24 and G21. Before phase 6, only the Railway that owns the Paraná Ferry Company may do so. A player who owns it when it closes loses its face value from his score (see 13.2). Without this option, the Paraná Ferry Company stays open for the whole game (see 14.4).

16.16 No Construction Companies

The three Construction Companies (BWW, J&MC and MEIG) do not exist, so there are only two kinds of corporation: Finance Houses and Railways. Everything else works as in the rest of this rulebook, with these changes.

- **Setup.** Each Finance House is dealt one seed Railway at random and holds a 10% seed in it, instead of a 20% seed in a Construction Company. Lombard Street receives the seed Railway that no Finance House holds, as in 11.1. Each Charter says which Railway its Finance House holds.
- **Starting.** On its turn in an Operating Round, a Finance House may start any Railway that has never been started: SFW, BB&NW, ANW or BA&P, whichever Finance House holds its seed share, or, from the first 4-train on, Entre Ríos. It starts it as a Construction Company starts one in 7.4: it pays at least $120 from its Treasury in steps of $5, the par is the highest par not above half the amount, and it takes the 20% president's certificate. A seed share held by another Finance House stays with it and counts as sold for the float. A Finance House may also restart a retired Railway (see 10.1). Lombard Street may start only Railways.
- **Money and control.** Dividends climb from a Railway to its Finance House and then to the player. Control, the emergency money (see 8.9) and the final score use the same chain with one tier fewer.
- **Mergers.** A Finance House may merge with another Finance House, or may propose a merger of two Railways when it presides over at least one of them. The same rules and the same merger styles apply. When a Finance House is merged away, the survivor takes its seed Railway.

17. Two Player Game (Prototype)

1887 can be played by two players. This is a prototype, and it may change after more play. All the rules above apply, with the changes in this section.

17.1 Setup

- Each player starts with $1,050.
- The certificate limit is the same as in a three player game.
- Estancia Land Grant is not used, as in a three player game.
- Use priority cards 1 and 2.
- Each player receives at random one 20% seed certificate in a different Finance House. The seed certificate of the third Finance House stays in its Treasury.

17.2 The Initial Auction

The auction works as in section 4, with these changes.

- The other player bids first, or passes. If he passes, the auctioneer takes the item at face value.
- If he bids, the auctioneer may raise or pass. The players then alternate, each bid at least $5 higher than the last and in multiples of $5. A player may never bid more than the cash they have.
- The auction ends when one player passes. The other player wins the item and pays their bid.
- The auctioneer role then passes to the other player.
- All three Charters are auctioned, so one player may win two Finance Houses.

17.3 Mergers

The contested merger needs a vote that cannot tie, so it cannot be used with two players. A two player game that is created with the contested merger uses the friendly merger. The purchase of control works as in 16.6.

17.4 Option: Third Chain Retired

This option is chosen when the game is created. It does nothing with three or four players. Only two Charters are auctioned. The third Finance House, chosen at random at setup, starts retired (see 10). Its Construction Company and that company's Railway have never been started, as usual, and the Finance House keeps its seed certificate in that Construction Company. Any player may start the Finance House as in 10.3.